Freezer Label Log

Date it, name it, find it later — the fridge-to-freezer, no-mystery system

HOW TO LABEL — THE 4 W'S

1. **WHAT** — "Beef chili" not "soup." Add seasonings: "Beef chili, mild."
2. **WHEN** — date frozen (month + day). Use the *freeze* date, not the cook date.
3. **WHERE/AMOUNT** — "2 portions" or "serves 4." Future-you deserves to know.
4. **USE-BY** — write the quality date: cooked meat dishes 3 months, raw ground 3–4 months (see storage sheet).

> Use freezer-rated labels and markers; cooler stickers soften and fall off. Masking tape + felt-tip works in a pinch — write, stick, done.

LABEL LOG (COPY ALL PAGES — ONE ROW PER ITEM)

ITEM (WHAT & AMOUNT)	DATE FROZEN	USE BY (QUAL.)	QTY / PORTIONS	NOTES	✓ USED

LABEL FORMAT

Sample label: `Beef chili · 2 qt (serves 4) · froz 10/25 · use by 1/25`

TRACKING HABITS

- Tape the log to the freezer door with a pencil on a string — low friction wins.
- Cross off rows when something gets eaten; start a new sheet when one fills.
- Keep one shelf for "eat first" items nearest their date.
- Tried one hard rule: *first in, first out* — grab the oldest date first.

Freezer safety reminder: food stays safe at 0 °F; the use-by column is quality, not safety. Write dates for **quality** (tastes best) and remember: if a thawed item smells off or looks strange — compost it, don't risk it.